became apparent to India that the Communists under Mao Zedong were overwhelming the Nationalist government led by Chiang Kai-shek. The Government of India was faced with the question of whether and when to recognize the new regime in Beijing. Within three months of Mao declaring from Tiananmen Square the establishment of the new People's Republic of China (PRC), India became one of the first countries to switch sides. The first chapter outlines the facts, how thinking evolved within the Government of India over the question of according diplomatic recognition to the new Chinese government, as well as how China approached this issue. Since this was the first diplomatic act between the two governments, it has seminal importance in terms of lessons for our diplomacy.

The Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between the Tibet Region of China and India of 29 April 1954 was another seminal event in our relations. Since the early part of the twentieth century, the British government in India showed interest in trade and political relations with Tibet. In 1914, after the Chinese Empire had collapsed, the British government concluded the Simla Convention and set up arrangements for trade and other matters directly between the Government of India and the Tibetan government, on the principle that the 1914 Convention deemed Tibet to be autonomous in its dealings with the British government although under the nominal suzerainty of China. In 1950, the People's Liberation Army (PLA) invaded Tibet in the name of liberating it. The Government of India was compelled to revisit its Tibet policy and to open discussions with the People's Republic of China in regard to the rights and privileges that it had enjoyed as the successor state to the British Indian government. The Chinese, on the other hand, looked with suspicion at the policy and actions of India, and were determined to gain total control over